

Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-07-13

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Psalm 116:1-19

- 1 I love the Lord, because He has heard My voice and my supplications.
 - 2 Because He has inclined His ear to me, Therefore I will call upon Him as long as I live.
 - 3 The pains of death surrounded me, And the pangs of Sheol laid hold of me; I found trouble and sorrow.
 - 4 Then I called upon the name of the Lord: "O Lord, I implore You, deliver my soul!"
 - 5 Gracious is the Lord, and righteous; Yes, our God is merciful.
 - 6 The Lord preserves the simple; I was brought low, and He saved me.
 - 7 Return to your rest, O my soul, For the Lord has dealt bountifully with you.
 - 8 For You have delivered my soul from death, My eyes from tears, And my feet from falling.
 - 9 I will walk before the Lord In the land of the living.
 - 10 I believed, therefore I spoke, "I am greatly afflicted."
 - 11 I said in my haste, "All men are liars."
 - 12 What shall I render to the Lord For all His benefits toward me?
 - 13 I will take up the cup of salvation, And call upon the name of the Lord.
 - 14 I will pay my vows to the Lord Now in the presence of all His people.
 - 15 Precious in the sight of the Lord Is the death of His saints.
 - 16 O Lord, truly I am Your servant; I am Your servant, the son of Your maidservant; You have loosed my bonds.
 - 17 I will offer to You the sacrifice of thanksgiving, And will call upon the name of the Lord.
 - 18 I will pay my vows to the Lord Now in the presence of all His people,
 - 19 In the courts of the Lord's house, In the midst of you, O Jerusalem. Praise the Lord!
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II. Key Summary

- Verses 1–2 say I love the Lord because He heard my voice and supplications, and I will call on Him all my life.
 - Verses 3–9 describe crying to God when the pains of death surrounded him; God is gracious and merciful, saved his life from death, and returned his soul to rest.
 - Verses 12–19 ask what shall I render to the Lord? — I will take up the cup of salvation, pay my vows, and offer the sacrifice of thanksgiving.
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III. Passage Analysis

Topic 1: Talk to Your Own Heart and Bring It Back to God

"Oh, learn this holy art; acquaint thyself with God, acquiesce in him, and be at peace." [1]

The psalmist speaks to his own soul: "Return to your rest, O my soul." The crisis had shaken him, and now he reminds himself that because the Lord has dealt bountifully with him, he can come back to calm. When your heart is racing, you can bring it back to God the same way.

Topic 2: You Can't Repay This Gift — So Keep Receiving From His Hand

"When we ask what we shall render to the Lord, we can offer no equivalent payment — only genuine gratitude." [2]

The psalmist asks, "What shall I render to the Lord for all His benefits?" — yet his answer is "I will take up the cup of salvation." Rather than scrambling to pay it off, he chooses to keep receiving God's salvation and then tell others how good He is.

IV. Reflection Question

Has anyone ever been so good to you that you thought, "How could I ever pay this back?" Psalm 116 asks "What shall I render to the Lord for all His benefits?" — and the answer is "I will take up the cup of salvation." With God you don't have to scramble to repay the debt; He wants you to keep receiving from His hand and to tell others how good He is.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik Commentary on Psalm 116 (citing John Trapp),
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/psalm-116/>

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry Commentary on Psalm 116,
https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/psa/psa_116.cfm